

Based on the number of recording surfaces, DVD is available as single side—single layer (also referred to as DVD5), single side—dual layer (DVD9), double side—single layer (DVD 10), and double side—dual layer (DVD 18). Dual-layer DVDs effectively doubled the storage capacity to 8.5 gigabytes (per side).

Based on the recording capabilities, DVDs can be categorised into DVD-ROM (read-only, usually the format for pre-manufactured DVDs), DVD-RAM (Random Access Memory, allowing reading and writing), DVD-R, and DVD+R (one-time recordable), DVD+RW & DVD-RW (rewriteable). The “+” and “-” in the nomenclature refer to the two incompatible formats offering the same features. Drives that are labelled as “super multi” are capable of playing all formats.

2.2.13 Erasing

Rewriteable media can be reused by erasing the existing contents. Erasing involves overwriting all areas on the disk with the same data. Erasing can be of two types: Quick Erase, where only the Table of Contents is erased, and Full Erase, where every sector on the disc is filled with the same pattern.

2.2.14 EVD

Enhanced Versatile Disc is a Chinese government-backed recording media for storing DVD video content. The need for this format arose since the licensing fees to be paid for DVD players to foreign companies were high. EVD is free from content protection techniques, and is (initially) available only in the read-only form.

2.2.15 FVD

Forward Versatile Disc is a technology promoted by the Taiwanese government to store High Definition video content. It uses the Microsoft Windows Media Video (WMV9) and Audio (WMA9) codecs for compressing the audio/video streams. It uses normal DVDs, but increases the track count to allow storage of 5.5 GB of data on a single layer, with the capability to have three layers on one side, giving a total storage capacity of 15 GB.